

nesses. We can now build parts, appliances and tools using a wide variety of materials all from the comforts of your home – just create or download a digital 3D model of the object of your choice and with just a click of a button, you can watch your 3D object take shape. The technology has been around for around 3 decades now, but off late however, rapid advances in processing power bandwidth and storage has seen this technology being catapulted into the limelight. Sure to be a force that changes the entire outlook of the manufacturing world, 3D printers have just started knocking on the doors of customers, and though not exactly a vital household good yet, it sure has the potential to become one in a few years' time. Already considerably cost competitive with 3D printers coming as cheap as a 100\$ (approx. 6000 Rs.), perhaps the biggest argument against 3D printers is the fact that it isn't extremely easy to use – and it's true to a huge extent. Aimed at the more experienced tinkerers, the current models aren't very user friendly, and just like past models of a fax machine or a printer, the consumers aren't likely to lap it up till it becomes extremely reliable and simple to use – push a button and get the job done. Till then, 3D printers aren't going to become a household item. But then, that day isn't too far away.



Peachy printer - 100\$ 3D printer

Future of 3D printing and what it means for traditional manufacturing

The future of 3D printing, and all the prospects that it seemingly holds for can make the least materialistic person salivate. And while this new reality is extremely exciting, there is significant doubt as to how this will affect manufacturing in the future. Factories won't disappear, but the manufacturing industry on the whole would get a massive makeover as new materials, new products and new materials emerge. Today's consumers are more customisation oriented. Customisation and speed of delivery are the name of the game today, and the traditional manufacturing units – no matter how advanced they've become – cannot compete with 3D printers in these areas. 3D printing at work or home changes the